

OTESSA 2024 Schedule

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Daily Schedule

Note

All times are Eastern Daylight Time

Current time in Montréal (click for more info)

June 12-15 @ McGill University

Time	Event	Location	Notes
6:30 - 7:30 am EDT	#OTESSA24 Morning Radio Show	VoicEd Radio	
10:30 am - 12:30 pm	Welcome Desk Open		
10:30 am - 12:30 pm	Conference Welcome, Announcements and LAnd Acknowledgement		LINK
11:00 am - 12:00 pm	Keynote		LINK - Jun12
			LINK - Jun13
			LINK - Jun14
			LINK - Jun15
12:00 - 12:30 pm	Break		

Time	Event	Location	Notes
12:30 - 1:15 pm	Parallel Sessions - Invited Speakers		LINK - Jun12 LINK - Jun13 LINK - Jun14 LINK - Jun15
1:15 - 1:30 pm	Break		
1:30 - 3:00 pm	Concurrent Sessions		LINK - Jun12 LINK - Jun13 LINK - Jun14 LINK - Jun15
3:00 - 3:45 pm	Break		
3:45 - 5:15 pm	Concurrent Sessions		LINK - Jun12 LINK - Jun13 LINK - Jun14 LINK - Jun15
	Discussion/Networking Pods		
	Congress Events		LINK
	OTESSA Social		

Part I

In Person @ McGill University

Wednesday, June 12

 Note!

In Person at McGill University

Current time in Montréal (click for more info)

8:00 - 9:00 | Continental Breakfast Provided

8:00-11:30 | Welcome Desk Open

9:00 - 9:15 | Conference Welcome, Announcements, & Land Acknowledgement

Trottier 0060 (Session A)

9:15 - 9:30 | Break

9:30-10:30 | Concurrent Session 1

Session 1.1 | Addressing Inequities

Card Sorting as a Methodology for Discovering Underlying Needs of Communities Seeking to Develop Learning Spaces: Towards a Better Understanding of the Sociocultural Ecology

Trottier 0060 (Session A) | Research

Marguerite Koole | *University of Saskatchewan*

Gordon Rugg | *Keele University*

Thiago Lemes de Oliveira | *Wolverhampton University*

Valentina Arancibia | *Federal University of Uberlândia*

Redouane Touati. | *Universidad Católica del Maule & Yahia Fares University, Médea*

i Abstract

In this paper, we focus on a knowledge elicitation method called single-criterion card sorting. To begin, we will provide a background two of the communities with whom we have been working: a Deaf and Hard of Hearing community in Canada and a community in Algeria. After briefly describing the context of the project, we will provide a description of, rationale for, and challenges with card sorting as a preliminary method. Next, we will explain the card-sorting procedures, present the preliminary data, and explain the analysis procedures. Although there are many kinds of card sorting, we will guide participants through a hands-on exercise using single-criterion card sorting (using both digital and in person techniques). Participants will learn about text-based, image-based, and object-based options, when to use card sorting, how to collect data, and how to analyse card sorting data through visual-numeric ‘heat maps’ (co-occurrence matrices). We can share a free Java-based software tool for generating heat maps.

Put simply, the paper provides a discussion of the data and how the data will guide the selection of subsequent knowledge modelling methods that will guide further analysis and hopefully help to gain a better, in-depth understanding of the communities’ needs and aspirations that may otherwise remain hidden beneath social, cultural, and linguistic barriers. With careful selection of knowledge modelling methods, we hope to help limit bias and the perpetuation of English and Western ways of doing and knowing. Meaningful consultation and collaboration can help to ensure that the communities’ interests remain at the heart of the project(s) and reduce Western (‘outsider’) control of research, analysis, and development.

Session 1.2 | Transitions of Online Learning and Teaching

Evolving our understanding of technology-integrated assessment: A review of the literature and development of a new framework

Trottier 2100 (Session C) | Research

Colin Madland | *University of Victoria*

Valerie Irvine | *University of Victoria*

Christopher DeLuca | *Queens University*

i Abstract

In this paper, we review the literature on technology in assessment in higher education and compare how the literature aligns with the Assessment in a Digital World framework (Bearman et al., 2022). We found themes in the literature that were not present in the framework (e.g., academic integrity and faculty workload) and constructs in the framework not evident in the literature (e.g., future self and future activities). Additionally, we consider other gaps in both the framework and the literature evident in day-to-day practices and government legislation or mandates, such as considering legal or ethical aspects of duty of care and the integration of Indigenous worldviews. We then developed the Technology-Integrated Assessment Framework to help instructors and administrators consider a broader range of constructs when planning assessment strategies in technology-integrated learning environments and to serve as a basis for further investigation into how the different constructs within the framework contribute to how we design, implement, and teach about assessment in digital learning environments today. We present an introduction of this technology-integrated assessment framework, invite feedback from the OTESSA community, and discuss future research goals and opportunities.

Session 1.3 | Addressing Inequities

Critical reflections on course materials: The rise of the single-use e-textbook and a university library's multi-pronged response

Trottier 2110 (Session D) | Research

Madelaine Vanderwerff & Sara Sharun | *Mount Royal University*

i Abstract

A recent shift by higher education publishers from print to digital content has led to an increase in course instructors adopting digital textbooks and courseware that are rented or sold directly to students. These digital courseware systems are attractive for a number of reasons: they are customizable, contain integrated value-added features, and are often marketed as inclusive, accessible, and cost-saving. However, there is debate about the impact of these tools on student learning and success, and about the challenges they create for learners, including restricting, controlling, and monitoring access and use. Our library has undertaken a number of distinct but related initiatives to support faculty in transitioning away from commercial textbooks in their courses. In this session, we will share a number of initiatives that invite faculty to critically reflect on course material selection, raise awareness about the challenges of commercial textbooks, and offer support

for transitioning to OER, freely available, or library-licensed materials in their courses. This session will share findings from our research and collaboration with stakeholders on campus.

Participants will be invited to share their experiences and discuss the potential long-term impacts of, and responses to, the commercialization and commodification of learning materials on their campuses.

10:30-11:00 | Break

11:00-12:00 | Concurrent Session 2 | Ethics in Design Showcase

All Session 2 Showcases are in the Trottier Mezzanine

Showcase 2.1 | Sustaining Positive Change

Design of Learning Experiences for Cyranoids & Echoborgs

Amanda Tkaczyk | *Independent Scholar*

i Abstract

Cyranoids are individuals whose communication is determined by another person in real time (Milgram S., 1992). Echoborgs, a subset of Cyranoids, are individuals whose communication is determined by artificial intelligent agents (Corti, K., & Gillespie, A., 2015). With the widespread adoption of generative artificial intelligence tools that will enable the next generation of Echoborgs with highly sophisticated tools to mediate their human-to-human interactions, we are thrilled to explore the design of educational experiences for Cyranoid and Echborg learners. This project will include instructional materials and tools to support the learning and professional development of Echoborgs in your classroom, community, and workplaces. Online attendees can review materials and interact with chatbots. In-person attendees will have the opportunity to engage with a kiosk of learning materials and practice their interactions with a live Echborg learner. This critical design project will present an exploration of how the future of education might adapt in response to AI-augmented & AI-dependent learners. We will explore themes of technology adoption, responsibility, ethics, equity, and care in this speculative educational design project.

Showcase 2.2 | Transitions of Online Learning and Teaching

Artifacts from the Futures of Higher Education

Elisa Arnold, Rocio Chavez Telleria & Laura Viselli | *eCampus Ontario*

Abstract

How we think about the future informs the decisions we make today; however, it is sometimes difficult to imagine what the future might look like. Foresight is a discipline and methodology that helps us think systematically about possible ways the future might play out and expands the solution space. Experiential futures, a subset of foresight methodology, is a way to consider different possible futures by interacting with imagined objects or environments of the future and develops capacity for futures thinking.

The Research and Foresight team at eCampusOntario has created four artifacts, grounded in foresight methodology, capturing different ways one can think about technology in higher education. These artifacts are based on the team's foresight trend research and explore possible future roles of technology. To facilitate the discussion and support analysis, we will use a foresight informed discussion toolkit developed by our team. This workshop will introduce attendees to the methodology of experiential futures to advance their capacity for futures thinking.

Showcase 2.3 | Addressing Inequities

Generative Friction: A Chatbot Interface Experiment

Ben Taylor & Devon Mordell | *McMaster University*

Abstract

Faced with the rapid adoption of generative artificial intelligence (GAI) in everyday life, educators are working to envision the role of this technology and routinely navigating its ethical use. Although the broader social, cultural, and environmental costs of the technology are well-documented, they are normally obscured by digital user interface experiences that “just work.” The practice-based design exhibit we are proposing is a GAI chatbot application that intentionally disrupts the user interface with details about the effects of each text input and output beyond the surface of the computer screen. Drawing on critical interface analyses, speculative design methods, and an interrogation of dark design patterns, we will attempt to make visible the past and potential future effects of GAI, including resource consumption, exploitative labour practices, perpetuation of biases, and an increase in economic divides. During this session, we will demo the

application and then allow for full audience engagement with the exhibit as we speak to the documentation of our design process. Our intention is to introduce a thoughtful and generative friction into the chat interaction, reclaiming so-called malicious techniques (e.g., distraction, interruption, obfuscation, and shock) to playful and socially productive ends.

Showcase 2.4 | Addressing Inequities

Decolonizing Educational Design: Toward Justice by Design in Higher Education

Rebecca Sweetman & Yasmine Djerbal | *Queen's University*

Abstract

As institutions commit to strategic initiatives for justice in higher education, this session shares practical ways to walk the decolonial talk in the design of education. Delving into critical design as a transformative tool and pedagogy, we seek to shift how storytellers in higher education craft their narratives. This presentation confronts how we, practically, design an equitable future of learning, including the applied skills required to recognize and challenge our normative biases and design assumptions, and transform our day-to-day work in educational design.

Examining how to mitigate curricular harms and consider the ethics of educational technologies, we introduce a justice by design framework that strategically dismantles oppressive, racist, and colonial epistemologies that unconsciously make their way into course design. Through this presentation, we practice design justice principles and share an open professional training curriculum called “[Activist Design in Educational Multimedia](#)” as an opportunity for intervention. The curriculum employs theoretical and practical techniques to develop the competencies and confidence of educational design professionals to apply an anti-oppressive lens in their work. This session presents a multifaceted, practical, and principled approach to critical design that can be integrated across roles, disciplines, and hierarchies to re-story the process and outcomes of educational design.

12:00 - 1:30 | Break

1:30- 2:30 | Keynote

Speaker Forthcoming

3:00 - 3:45 | Concurrent Session 3 | Sustaining Positive Change

Trottier 0060 (Session A)

3:00 - 3:20 | Session 3.1

Supporting OER Adoptions through Federated Discoverability

Practice

Don Eldridge | *eCampus Ontario*

i Abstract

A key aspect of supporting OER adoption remains OER discoverability, which is commonly reported as a barrier to OER adoption as part of finding relevant resources and the time required to adopt (Belikov, & Bodily, 2016; Lantrip & Ray, 2021). This open data initiative includes the development of a metadata schema with crosswalks, technical configurations using Open Archives Initiative Protocol for Metadata Harvesting, and a collaborative pilot project to test and implement the technical solution. At the time of this proposal submission, the initiative is federating out the library metadata records to 24 post-secondary institutions. Lessons learned include working with consortiums and shared technology services, evaluating the value of federation for a wide range of post-secondary institutions, and the impact for future collaborations.

3:25 - 3:45 | Session 3.2 | Sustaining Positive Change

Means to an End? Ethical Methodologies for Developing Ethical Facial Recognition Training Datasets

Research

Jin Sol Kim, Amanda Yu, Lai-Tze Fan & Tatum Weicker-O'Connor | *University of Waterloo*

i Abstract

In January of 2020, The New York Times published a report on the implications of Clearview AI's facial recognition system in law enforcement. However, unlike other discussions of facial recognition in this field, which focus on the consequences of racial biases within the system, this report revealed the problematic methodology behind the development of Clearview AI's robust training dataset, calling for an examination of ethics in the very process of creating ethical tech. Clearview AI has since been banned in countries including Canada for scraping over three billion photos from social media platforms, breaching privacy laws surrounding consent for use of personal data. Yet the challenge remains: how can we create a fair and robust training dataset for facial recognition algorithms given the resource-intensive nature of the task as well as complications such as the limitations of data privacy? How can we ensure that the means of creating ethical facial recognition technologies mirror its ends? With current rapid developments in generative AI, synthetic training datasets have newly emerged as a promising player in the field of facial recognition technologies. Training datasets such as Digi-Face 1M that are entirely composed of generated images seem to waive the need for ethical considerations altogether by skirting the use of human subjects. Nevertheless, insofar as the application of these tools affect human lives, we must question whether this new method of dataset development is truly free from ethical concerns.

3:45 - 4:00 | Break

4:00 - 4:30 | Concurrent Session 4

Session 4.1 | Transitions of Online Learning and Teaching

Trottier 2100 (Session C)

Planning, living, and adding to our plates: : K-3 educators' experiences of curricula in Virtual Learning Environments (VLE)

Practice Melissa Bishop | *University of Prince Edward Island*

i Abstract

Virtual Learning Environments (VLE) have interested scholars since the late 20th century, with much of the research focusing on secondary and post-secondary instructors and learners (Brown, 2010; Dabbagh, 2007; Fuchs, 2014; Plump & LaRosa, 2017; Proserpio

& Gioia, 2007). With the onset of VLEs in elementary education due to the COVID-19 pandemic and the continuation of synchronous virtual learning thereafter, VLEs have become commonplace in K-3 contexts across Ontario. Yet, as we contend with the ubiquitous nature of technology in early elementary, a paucity of literature exists regarding teachers' and Early Childhood Educators' (ECE) experiences of planned and lived curricula (Muldong et al., 2021; Aperribai et al., 2020; Ferdig et al., 2020) in VLEs. Starting from standpoint epistemologies (Au, 2012; Harding, 1991; Haraway, 2003), reflecting on five narrative interviews, and employing a narrative analysis of field texts (Clandinin, 2006; Clandinin & Connelly, 1988, 1996, 2000), we unearthed six narrative threads: time, parent communication, relationship building, classroom community, engagement and teacher presence, and technological challenges. These six threads suggested how ECEs and teachers navigated the entanglements of planned and lived curricular experiences in VLEs. Further, the five threads exposed critical elements to be considered in future VLE policy and curricular reform in the K-3 context.

Session 4.2 | Transitions of Online Learning and Teaching

Tech-based teaching practices and student engagement from the perspective of self-determination theory

Trottier 2110 (Session D)

Géraldine Heilporn, Mourad Majdoub & Fatme Diab | *Université Laval*

Abstract

Teachers can enhance inclusion and provide personalized learning experiences for students by utilizing digital tools and prioritizing inclusive teaching methods (Kim et al., 2019). However, Cabellos et al. (2023) have argued that digital resources were used more to transmit information than to engage students in their learning. The widespread and necessary use of ICT has not served to make learning student-centered but was primarily aimed at the transmission and evaluation of the content. Thus, students' motivation and engagement are significantly affected, worsening the existing issues regarding low school motivation, especially in secondary school (Cai et al., 2022). In response to these research gaps, the aim of this communication is to explore high school teachers' technology-based teaching methods that motivate and address the needs of learners with the use of technology based on the digital divide framework (Van Dijk, 2020), SDT (Self-Determination Theory) (Ryan & Deci, 2017) and student engagement model (Archambault et al., 2019). We have conducted individual semi-structured interviews with high school teachers aiming to obtain in-depth qualitative data mainly through open-ended questions. A thematic analysis has been employed to inductively analyze the interview data and generate pos-

sible themes and categories based on the objectives of our study. The findings and recommendations for future research will be shared at OTESSA conference.

Session 4.3 | Sustaining Positive Change

Open Learning Design in an Inquiry-based Educational Setting

Research

Trottier 0070 (Session B)

Maryam Shirdel Pour & Michael Paskevicius | *University of Victoria*

i Abstract

Inquiry-based learning as a pedagogical approach encourages students to explore and investigate real-world problems and foster a deeper understanding of concepts as they actively connect new information to their existing mental frameworks (Martell, 2022). Educators are increasingly recognizing the value of creating an engaged learning environment that promotes collaboration and allows for personalized and meaningful learning experiences (Bui & Khoo, 2020). Inquiry-based learning may require that learners engage in networking beyond formal academic settings and connect with professionals, peers, and resources in various fields that could foster their deeper engagement with learning (Robert, 2022).

Open Educational Practices (OEP) tend to create cooperative teaching and learning practices in which the focus is on the role of the learners and the impact that their participation will have on the learning process and practice (Mayrberger, 2020; DeRosa & Robinson, 2017; Author. 2019). Students could benefit from the principles of OEP to engage in open and dynamic conversations to collectively build a deeper understanding of the subject and share their ideas and inquiry work widely while following copyright guidelines. This study, therefore, aspires to investigate the effects of incorporating OEP in an educational environment centred around inquiry.

5:00 - 7:00

See Congress Programming for Social Tent & Food Options

7:00 - 11:59 | OTESSA Social

Thursday, June 13

 Note!

In Person at McGill University

Current time in Montréal (click for more info)

8:00 - 9:00 | Continental Breakfast Provided

8:00-11:30 | Welcome Desk Open

9:00 - 9:15 | Conference Welcome, Announcements, & Land Acknowledgement

Trottier 0060 (Session A)

9:15 - 9:30 | Break

9:30-10:30 | Concurrent Session 5

Session 5.1 | Addressing Inequities

Trottier 0060 (Session A) | Practice (French)

Franchir les obstacles : Améliorer l'accessibilité grâce aux ressources éducatives libres dans l'apprentissage intégré au travail

Andrea Krasznai | *eCampus Ontario*

Abstract

Le projet d'apprentissage expérientiel d'eCampusOntario, le Consortium d'apprentissage expérientiel francophone de l'Ontario (CAPFO), rassemble les institutions postsecondaires francophones et bilingues de l'Ontario pour combler une lacune : le manque d'opportunités d'apprentissage expérientiel dans les environnements francophones et bilingues. En utilisant la plateforme Riipen, nous offrons aux membres du CAPFO la possibilité d'augmenter le nombre d'opportunités disponibles pour leurs apprenants au-delà des frontières géographiques de la province.

Dans le cadre de ce projet, une nouvelle lacune a été mise en lumière : le manque de ressources en français pour les professeur.e.s souhaitant s'impliquer dans l'apprentissage intégré au travail. eCampusOntario a créé des ressources éducatives libres (REL) pour soutenir les professeur.e.s dans le développement de leurs connaissances en matière d'apprentissage intégré au travail. De plus, une enquête de recherche a été menée dans le secteur francophone de l'Ontario pour dévoiler les tendances et les défis, désormais disponibles sous forme de rapport REL dans la bibliothèque ouverte d'eCampusOntario, la plus grande bibliothèque ouverte au Canada.

Au cours de notre session, nous fournirons des informations sur ce qu'est le CAPFO et mettrons en lumière les exigences particulières de la communauté minoritaire franco-ontarienne engagée dans l'apprentissage intégré au travail (AIT). Nous aborderons ensuite les ressources éducatives libres (REL), comment elles peuvent améliorer l'expérience des professeur.e.s dans l'AIT et dévoilerons quelques conclusions clés de notre rapport. Finalement, nous fournirons à notre public un guide REL afin qu'ils puissent initier l'expérimentation et la création de leurs propres REL.

Session 5.2 | Wildcard

Trottier 0070 (Session B) | Practice

9:30 - 10:30 | Unveiling the Future of Language Teaching and Acquisition: Exploring the Conflation of Cultural Historical Activity Theory, and Generative AI

Tanya Dixit & Michael Paskevicius | *University of Victoria*

Abstract

Contemporary technology trends in education are profoundly reshaping the design of teaching and learning languages. This trajectory, Li (2017) observes, can be largely attributed to the “development of learning theories and pedagogical considerations” (p.3) alongside several other contributing factors, a sentiment echoed by Blake (2009) and

Heift and Chapelle (2012) who confirm the far-reaching influence and potential of CALL, which further offers substantial promise to refine and enhance second language (L2) acquisition. Moreover, these scholars unanimously agree that technology integration and implementation should be firmly grounded in research built upon theoretical foundations. Hence, conjoining Cultural Historical Activity Theory (CHAT) (Engeström, 1987) and the affordances of generative AI, exemplified by ChatGPT, this presentation looks at transformative opportunities in which current AI bots can reform classroom teaching-learning discourse. This comprehensive awareness about AI's potentiality to revamp instructional methods, improve learner engagement, and offer avenues for personalizing and differentiating instruction is to be deemed essential not only for equipping stakeholders with the knowledge to navigate the nuances and challenges inherent in optimizing language acquisition experiences, but also to set the stage for a future where learners and educators can seamlessly integrate cutting-edge tools and technologies into improving the language acquisition experience.

10:00 - 10:30 | Personalized learning path in a course on digital technology for secondary education programs

Géraldine Heilporn, Alexandre Lepage, Audrey Raynault & Julie Chamberland |
Université Laval

i Abstract

This communication presents the new design of a course on digital technology for teaching and learning, offered to students enrolled in secondary education programs at Laval University (Quebec), based on the concept of adaptive learning. Following a diagnostic assessment questionnaire of their digital competency at the beginning of the semester, students are automatically assigned to three thematic activities aimed to develop their digital competency for transfer to secondary education. After working on a thematic activity for one week, students return to the classroom for peer-to-peer teaching and learning on these thematic activities, in a blended course modality alternating asynchronous (thematic activities) and synchronous classes (peer-to-peer teaching and learning). Temporary thematic support communities as well as disciplinary learning communities are set to encourage peer collaboration and support throughout the semester. At given time-points during the semester, students also have to assess their peer collaboration and give them feedback a peer evaluation mechanism.

Session 5.3 | Sustaining Positive Change

Trottier 2100 (Session C)

9:30 - 10:30 | Developments in National OER Advocacy in Canada

Ann Ludbrook | *Toronto Metropolitan University*

Michael McNally | *University of Alberta*

Abstract

This 50-minute session builds upon the Canadian Association Research Libraries (CARL)'s National Advocacy Framework for Open Educational Resources (OER) in Canada (2023). It updates attendees on national OER advancements, and features insights from the Indigenous Knowledges and OER summit held in Vancouver in February 2024. The summit produced principles for working with Indigenous knowledges in OER, alongside discussions on progressing national OER advocacy. The session covers developments in policy, infrastructure, and francophone OER stemming from summits in 2022 and 2023. Reports from these events will be discussed, along with updates on ongoing federal budget consultations and the anticipated 2025 federal election. The audience will also have the opportunity to contribute ideas and strategies for national advocacy, via group discussion and polls.

10:30-11:00 | Break

11:00-12:00 | Concurrent Session 6 | Ethics in Design Showcase

All Session 6 Showcases are in the Trottier Mezzanine

Showcase 6.1 | Sustaining Positive Change

Redesigning Computing for Openness - the Ethics of Consuming Devices

Brian Sutherland | *University of Toronto*

Abstract

Have you started to accumulate old computing devices? Why does the logic of computing involve repeated purchase and consumption of expensive “molded plastic epics” (Gabrys, 2011)? Thinking back on calculation devices and this ethical problem of repeated consumption, the simple solar calculator stands out for its durability – an energy harvesting strategy that doesn’t use batteries, and it doesn’t wear out. Fifty year old solar powered calculators and other electronic devices which still work may be found. In

this session, proposed for the Ethics in Design Conference Strand, I will review the history of energy harvesting information devices and their significant characteristics around sustainability, present response designs which engage various ethical questions around consumption, carbon production and degrowth, and discuss their usefulness as open designs and thought-artifacts in an iterative speculative design conversation around climate change.

Showcase 6.2 | Sustaining Positive Change

A framework and model for engagement in open, online spaces

Michelle Harrison | *Thompson Rivers University*

Michael Paskevicius | *University of Victoria*

Abstract

This design case provides an analysis of the creation of an innovative open educational practices (OEP) project “Rethink Learning Design”, designed to explore and implement critical approaches to learning and instructional design. We recognized that if we want to embrace the power of OEP to change teaching and learning practice we need to enable spaces that honor multiple voices and perspectives, co-create knowledge and challenge traditional roles and hierarchies supported in open pedagogical approaches. Two key goals guided our project: the development of a reader/resource based on open pedagogy principles, emphasizing inclusivity and participation, and the integration of a reflective practice framework to deepen engagement and bring about a shift in educational practices. In this session and design case we will outline our iterative design process, ethical considerations, and theoretical foundations, and student use and feedback, with the aim of sharing insights and templates for practitioners in diverse educational contexts. We will consider how we can approach design as a theory of action and consider ways to promote learner ownership, open scholarship, anonymity, and options for permanence through our learning design tool.

Showcase 6.3 | Addressing Inequities

Cultural Dimensions of Ethics in Design: Indigenous Knowledge & Online Course Media

Brian Lorraine | *Simon Fraser University*

i Abstract

This session delves into the intricate design process of an online Indigenous Ethnozoology course, exploring the tensions, challenges, and ethical considerations encountered during an 8-month redesign and development period. Originally authored by a Squamish knowledge holder, the course featured recorded lectures intertwining oral histories with western scientific perspectives. The transition to a new instructor, a professor of white settler descent, prompted critical reflection on retaining Indigenous knowledge while improving instructional effectiveness. Drawing on cognitive load theory and empirical studies on video engagement, the design team navigated the complexities of honoring oral traditions while enhancing student learning experiences. This case study highlights the necessity for robust frameworks addressing Indigenous knowledge protocols in educational design, underscored by ongoing critical reflection to confront colonial legacies and promote ethical practices.

Showcase 6.4 | Addressing Inequities

Moving Towards Design Justice through Multivocal Design in Health Education

Danielle Dilkes | *University of Western Ontario*

i Abstract

This Design Case features an interprofessional stroke care case for health and medical education that was developed through a participatory design process. The objectives of the case were to highlight the complexities of interprofessional care and prepare learners for interprofessional practice. The approach to developing this case draws on key Design Justice principles: those most impacted by a design should be central in the design process and that various types of expertise exist and have value. The stroke care case was co-developed with patients, or Lived Experience Experts (LEEs), and all members of an interdisciplinary stroke care team, or Subject Matter Experts (SMEs). Patients were invited to share their real experience of stroke care, which became the basis of the case. Each health care professional was given full control over how their roles were portrayed, and invited to craft and star in their scenes within the case. This process resulted in a multivocal media rich case that more accurately reflects real patient experience and the real scope of practice for different health professionals. In our Design Case Exhibit, we will share multimedia components of the final case, but we will also share design knowledge in support of a more general framework for participatory design that could account for some of the complications of co-design across institutional roles.

12:00 - 1:30 | Break

1:30 - 2:15 | Concurrent Session 7

Trottier 2100 (Session C)

Session 7.1 | Sustaining Positive Change

An e-Book of One's Own: Empowering Student Learning Journeys

Practice

Terry Greene & Christian Metaxas | *Trent University*

i Abstract

Join our interactive session to explore the transformative initiative, “An e-Book of One’s Own,” designed to reshape the student experience in higher education. In a dynamic environment, participants will engage with Pressbooks, a powerful tool enabling students to craft personalized e-books showcasing their academic journey. The session emphasizes hands-on exploration, collaborative problem-solving, and interactive structures to work towards successful implementation. Reflective exercises simulate the student experience, fostering a deep understanding of the program’s impact. This session is not a passive presentation; it’s a collective effort to redefine educational experiences. Attendees will leave with practical insights, strategies for implementation, and a renewed vision for empowering students through digital innovation.

Session 7.2 | Wildcard & Transitions of Online Learning and Teaching

Trottier 2110 (Session D)

1:30 - 1:50 | Triads to Complete Capstone: e-Portfolios

Practice

Christine Ho Younghusband | *University of Northern British Columbia*

Abstract

For one graduate program at a small research university in British Columbia, completing a digital portfolio is one option for capstone to demonstrate learning and conclude the program. The portfolio option includes developing a WordPress site, articulating one's learning through the lens of a guided question, and a presentation of the portfolio to a committee. The student and committee members are led by a faculty supervisor. Completion of this capstone can be an isolating experience. In one term, two graduate students were left without a supervisor and needed to complete the program that term. One faculty member supervised three graduate students at one time. Over time, the three graduate students formed a triad, or small learning community, where they supported, peer-assessed, and collaborated in an ongoing way to complete their portfolios. The outcomes were personalized and unique to the learner. This presentation is a program evaluation that investigates the value and impact of triads during capstone and portfolio to invite back humanity into the capstone and portfolio experience.

1:55 - 2:15 | Using AI to design a Culturally Responsive STEM course and improve sense of belonging among students

Research

Nahid Pourdolat Safari & Behnoosh Khoramrooz | *University of Victoria*

Abstract

This session aims to explore the integration of AI in Culturally Responsive Teaching (CRT) to enhance the sense of belonging in STEM education. Focusing on the importance of CRT in developing a sense of belonging and as a result, in enhancing motivation, engagement, persistence and academic performance, this presentation will discuss the theoretical foundations of CRT and explore implementing AI-generated content in STEM course design to foster a more inclusive learning environment. This session will delve into how AI can validate and acknowledge students' cultural backgrounds in STEM classes with a focus on underrepresented groups, including Indigenous, Black and international students. By showcasing practical examples, this session intends to demonstrate how AI technologies can be used to motivate and engage STEM students from diverse cultural backgrounds by improving their sense of belonging.

2:15 - 2:45 | Break

2:45 - 3:45 | Unconference

3:45 - 4:00 | Break with Coffee & Snack Provided

4:00 - 4:30 | Concurrent Session 8

Session 8.1 | Addressing Inequities

Trottier 2100 (Session C)

Survivors of Complex Trauma as Adult Online Learners

Research

Hilary Schmidt | *Thompson Rivers University*

i Abstract

Complex trauma is both a product and a source of significant multidimensional inequality, including profound disruption to survivors' educational trajectories. Nonetheless, little research has been conducted on trauma-informed educational practices for adult/postsecondary or open/online learners, and educational researchers have largely ignored the perspectives of survivors, contradicting the key principle of collaboration within a trauma-informed approach.

This qualitative instrumental collective case study explored how adults with a history of complex trauma experience postsecondary open/online learning. Findings included participants' struggles with executive functioning, challenges regulating emotion and dealing with a heightened perception of threat, re-experiencing trauma, negative beliefs about the self, and difficulties navigating relationships. These trauma impacts affected not only participants' learning and course experience, but also their experience of applying, registering, and accessing financial aid. Nonetheless, participants are demonstrably skilled in managing impacts of their trauma and are driven to learn, placing the highest intrinsic value on education. Top priorities for implementation of trauma-informed educational practices identified by participants included establishing safety; trust and transparency; and empowerment, voice, and choice. Implications are discussed, including enhancing equity and inclusion for survivors of complex trauma and assisting open/online postsecondary institutions in meeting their unique needs through implementation of trauma-informed educational practices.

Session 8.2 | Addressing Inequities

Trottier 2110 (Session D)

Protecting Indigenous Knowledge in Open Education

Don Eldridge & Mary Gu | *eCampus Ontario*

Abstract

As open educational practices (OEP) and open educational resources (OER) grants, programs, and initiatives are created by organizations, there is a need to consider the diverse and nuanced Equity, Decolonization, Diversity, and Inclusion (EDDI) issues that will be surfaced. Funding institutions and agencies must consider how their support and promotion of OEP and OER may not support and may even alienate Indigenous members of their community. This presentation will provide an overview of the EDDI concerns faced in a major investment into an OER program in Canada that impacted multiple postsecondary institutions through 3 years of work. This presentation will share the development process of a geographically specific Commons license, the metrics on uptake since the launch of the license, and the impact on supporting digital-by-design virtual learning. This experience can inform the broader open education community by sharing lessons learned and best practices as a case study.

Session 8.3 | Sustaining Positive Change

Trottier 0060 (Session A)

Creating Reskilling and Upskilling Opportunities for Internationally Educated Immigrants through Online Learning Programs: The Story of Success

Practice

Marina Grineva | *Intercultural Skills Lab (Rotman School of Management, University of Toronto)*

Abstract

The importance of access to reskilling and upskilling opportunities for immigrants can't be overestimated. However, there is a number of challenges that this population faces while trying to integrate into the workforce or advance in their careers in Canadian work

environments. One of such challenges is the inability to attend professional development programs in-person. From this perspective, technology-enhanced learning, specifically, on-line or hybrid learning environments (a combination of asynchronous and synchronous learning sessions) are one of the solutions of the problem.

In this presentation, we aim to provide the overview of professional development programs offered by [The Intercultural Skills Lab](#) (Rotman School of Management, University of Toronto) that successfully provides reskilling and upskilling opportunities for internationally trained immigrants by creating a variety of technology-enhanced learning environments. Specifically, we will demonstrate how through the use of a number of online learning tools the program participants are given an opportunity to become part of vibrant collaborative learning communities fostering professional development in such areas as intercultural intelligence, effective communication, career management, as well as in the sector-specific disciplines.

5:00 - 7:00

See Congress Programming for Social Tent & Food Options

7:00 - 11:59 | OTESSA Social

Friday, June 14

 Note!

In Person at McGill University

Current time in Montréal (click for more info)

8:00 - 9:00 | Continental Breakfast Provided

8:00-11:30 | Welcome Desk Open

9:00 - 9:15 | Conference Welcome, Announcements, & Land Acknowledgement

Trottier 0060 (Session A)

9:15 - 9:30 | Break

9:30-10:30 | Concurrent Session 9

Session 9.1 | Transitions of Online Learning and Teaching

Trottier 2110 (Session D)

9:30 - 10:30 | How do students make sense of a Learning Analytic Dashboard? Exploring learners' perceptions and plans

Research

Mariel Miller & Emma Graves | *University of Victoria*

i Abstract

Student-facing learning analytic dashboards (LADs) claim to help students manage their learning. However, many widely available LADs can be inflexible and lack consideration of the contemporary theory and research of learning. Furthermore, it is unclear how students use information presented in LADs and translate it into meaningful action. This descriptive study investigates students' use of a learning analytic dashboard to inform goal-setting and achievement over the course of one week in a large, hybrid undergraduate course. Specifically, we explore (a) learners' evaluations of their course progress after interacting with the LAD (b) types of goals set by students for managing their learning during the week, post-interaction with the LAD; (c) the extent to which learners achieved their goals; and (d) students' perceptions of LAD utility in supporting them to manage their learning. Data were collected through two questionnaires administered at the midpoint of a course. Preliminary findings indicate that after viewing the dashboard, most learners set goals for maintaining their current progress during the week by focusing on their motivation. However, most learners reported failing to fully attain their goal by the end of the week. Implications for supporting learner engagement with LADs students-facing learning analytic dashboards are discussed.

10:00 - 10:30 | Building/Belonging: An Exploration of Digital and Place-Based Belonging Practices at [Redacted]

Research

Bonnie Stewart | *University of Windsor*

i Abstract

This presentation overviews a case study of belonging, considered and framed through the lens of both place-based identity and digital education. The case study project under discussion aims to build on the established digital practices of a distributed European higher and further education institution, with multiple regional campuses, which serve to make education accessible and inclusive to a remote population otherwise underserved. The session will present the lit review, design, and goals of the case study project, while exploring ideas of community belonging in traditionally diasporic regions as well as dig-

ital belonging in online classrooms. It will explore the affordances and impacts of both, and the ways the two may or may not intersect in this particular context. This project extends the exemplary research and practice being done at this institution with digital technologies, in hopes of making visible the ties between geographic and cultural belonging practices and those that can be amplified and supported digitally. This institution's inclusive and accessible approaches may be of value to the OTESSA audience in a time when belonging is a need for students in many contexts.

Session 9.2 | Sustaining Positive Change

Trottier 0070 (Session B) | Practice

9:30 - 10:30 | Walk the Walk: Fostering Equitable Practices in Organizational Sustainability

Apurva Ashok & Kaitlin Schilling | *The Rebus Foundation*

Abstract

How do equitable practices show up in the workplace? In our pursuit of different goals, we often forget the journey and careful, collective organization it takes to get and hold us there.

In the discourse around building equitable futures, this session makes space to think about organizational sustainability and designing intentional work practices for long-lasting and widespread impact. Our approach extends beyond addressing external stakeholders and emphasizes modeling equitable practices internally — at the individual level and collectively within the organization.

The presentation will delve into the flexible work model we have developed that prioritizes organizational mission and the people and work to implement the mission. Our model looks at goals beyond just profitability and instead asks how we can sustain individuals, foster critical reflection, and create positive organizational change. We will showcase how equitable practices manifest in daily team interactions, board discussions, strategic direction, programming, and resource utilization.

While the principles we embrace are not groundbreaking, they are critical to the welfare and long-term success of an organization. Our focus is intentionally on the often-overlooked aspect of applying equity-minded principles within the organizational context. The presentation aims to cement the significance of iterative daily practices in sustaining a culture of equity and inclusion within educational organizations.

Session 9.3 | Addressing Inequities

Trottier 2100 (Session C)

9:30 - 10:30 | Is AI for or Against Human Success? An Exploratory Engagement by Female Scholars

Practice

Judith Pete | *Tangaza University College*

Gelareh Keshavarz | *Athabasca University*

Jenni Hayman | *Royal Roads University*

Abstract

In this practice-focused session, an educator from Kenya and two educators from Canada will compare access to and experiences of artificial intelligence (AI) tools for work and education in their professional contexts. Topics will include learner, educator, and institutional access to the Internet and devices in general—and access and use of AI tools, specifically. The presenters will share emerging concerns about the ethics of the design and use of AI tools and share their interests and the positive potential they see for the use of these tools. Participants attending the session will be invited to share their ideas, contexts, interests, and concerns about AI as contributions to group learning. Strategies for ethical and pedagogic review of AI tools will be shared.

10:30-11:00 | Break

11:00-12:00 | Poster Session

Information forthcoming.

12:00 - 1:30 | Break

1:30 - 2:15 | Concurrent Session 10

Session 10.1 | Wildcard

Trottier 2100 (Session C)

1:30 - 1:50 | Dangling in Between: Investigating the Impacts of Using AI in Higher Education Research

Research

Todd Milford & Sara Fallahi | *University of Victoria*

i Abstract

Artificial intelligence (AI) is used in education since 2015 (Vincent-Lancrin & van der Vlies, 2020). Benefits and hindrances of using AI has been debated in many academic literature (Chen et al., 2020; Crompton & Song, 2021; Verma & Tomar, 2021). Today with the rise of AI tools which are available to the public, with students using them more, and universities clarifying their stance on the topic, investigating the impacts of using AI in education is more crucial than ever. The purpose of this paper is to investigate the impacts of using AI tools for graduate students. For this aim, participants were introduced to a few AI tools to use for writing literature review. Participants were also interviewed on their experience and opinion on using AI in research. Initial findings of this research suggest that the participants could benefit from using AI, for example in saving time while researching, although some concerns remained unsolved for them. The output of this research can be considered while integrating AI in higher education as well as policy making.

1:55 - 2:15 | OER in the context of generative AI

Practice

Normand Roy | *University of Montreal*

Abstract

This proposal explores the transformation of OER in the context of Artificial Intelligence (AI), examining the multifaceted relationship between these two domains. While highlighting the potential benefits of AI in personalizing learning, creating new resources, and enhancing accessibility, the proposal also confronts the challenges associated with authorship and ethical considerations of AI-generated content. Focusing on strategies to navigate these challenges while ensuring the integrity of original contributions, the proposal further investigates how advanced AI techniques like fine-tuning and Retrieval Augmented Generation (RAG) can be employed to create highly adaptive and personalized OER aligned with learners' needs. Additionally, it explores the potential of AI in generating multimodal resources, potentially overcoming language, literacy, and learning preference barriers to broaden access to education globally. Ultimately, this proposal aims to leverage AI while addressing its inherent challenges, ultimately enhancing the quality, accessibility, and adaptivity of OER.

Session 10.2 | Transitions of Online Learning and Teaching

Trottier 2110 (Session D)

1:30 - 1:50 | Undergraduate Students as Research Partners: Lessons Learned in a Scoping Review of Social Media in Teaching and Learning

Research

Emma Duke, Linh Bui, & Richard Hayman | *Mount Royal University*

Abstract

After 20+ years of educators incorporating various social media into their undergraduate teaching and learning, we have identified the need to critically examine the existing body of literature on social media integration in higher learning to understand how this use has been studied as well as how it informs today's teaching and learning processes. This presentation reports on our scoping review project exploring trends, gaps, and issues in the use of social media technologies in undergraduate teaching and learning contexts. The researchers, including two undergraduate student research partners, will refer to the project protocol (author3 & author4, 2023) and present initial findings and lessons learned during the project to-date. We will also discuss meta-research implications from these initial findings, including an exploration of partnering with undergraduate student RAs on a rigorous evidence synthesis project, with the latter delivered primarily from the perspective of the student partners.

1:55 - 2:15 | Flexibility and Foresight in Ontario Postsecondary Education: Voices from the Field

Practice

Elisa Arnold, Rocio Chavez Telleria & Laura Viselli | *eCampusOntario*

Abstract

Flexibility has emerged as a key area to support digital transformation in postsecondary education, and educators are often at the forefront of implementation. To understand how educators are thinking and feeling, we engaged with 45 educators from Ontario's publicly-supported postsecondary institution through six virtual workshops using foresight methods to frame the conversations. Foresight is a formal, systematic way of thinking about the future, which offers a way to think about how the future might play out and expand the solution space. Specifically, we used the following foresight methods: Futures Triangle, to understand the interrelationships among future visions, present drivers of change, and past limitations; Causal Layered Analysis (CLA), to explore the assumptions that underlie the way we frame problems, situations, and solutions; and Three Horizons, to explore what would it take to transition from present situations to future visions. This presentation is a summary of the research about these educators think and feel about flexibility in post secondary education, including considerations of equity and ethics and the application to practice, policy and infrastructure and recommended next steps.

2:15 - 2:45 | Break

2:45 - 3:45 | Concurrent Session 11

Trottier 0070 (Session B)

Session 11.1 | Addressing Inequities

Challenging Stereotypes: The Role of The Matilda Project in STEM Gender Equality

Workshop

Shehroze Saharan | *University of Guelph*

Abstract

The Matilda Effect - a term coined by Yale historian Margaret W. Rossiter - is a phenomenon used to describe women scientists who have been ignored, forgotten, or denied credit due to sex-linked biases. The unfortunate reality is that the Matilda Effect is still prevalent today as women are not given due credit for their scientific achievements. The Matilda Project (<https://www.thematildaproject.com/>), a higher education initiative committed to shedding light on the pervasive issue of gender inequality in STEM, stands strategically poised to tackle this challenge. Positioned as an open-access resource, The Matilda Project encompasses the creation of educational videos and a website. The videos offer concise insights into key topics, while the website will host interactive activities and will serve as a comprehensive collection showcasing both historical and contemporary women scientists who share a common experience—the Matilda Effect.

Session 11.2 | Sustaining Positive Change

Trottier 2100 (Session C)

Empowering Student Voices: Integrating Stop-Motion Animation with Google Drawing, Canva, and Cap Cut

Practice

Patricia Dennis | *Pride Academy Charter School*

Abstract

In designing Project Based Learning (PBL) curriculum and units that focus on real-world issues related to diversity, sustainability, and justice, students will create hands-on projects that evoke change within themselves, their communities, and globally. In this interactive and engaging in-person workshop, educators will be immersed in a comprehensive session focused on harnessing the potential of stop-motion animation using Google Draw, Canva, and Cap Cut. The central objective of this workshop is to empower educators with the expertise and tools to integrate the engineering design process into their teaching methods, fostering student creativity and innovation while amplifying their voices through modern technology. Throughout the workshop, participants will explore how to utilize Project-Based Learning (PBL) to sustain positive change and explore the UN Global Goals, aiming to equip educators with the necessary resources and strategies to facilitate meaningful learning experiences for their students.

Session 11.3 | Addressing Inequities

Trottier 2110 (Session D)

2:45 - 3:45 | Unleashing Potential: Exploring Open Education Initiatives with TRU Open Press

Practice

Danielle Collins, Marie Bartlett, Brenna Gray, Jessica, Kaitlyn Meyers, Jon Fulton, Natasha Ramroop Singh & Ananya Kamboj | *Thompson Rivers University*

Abstract

Join us at the OTESSA conference as we highlight the transformative impact of the Thompson Rivers University (TRU) Open Press. As proponents of open education, we aim to demonstrate how the TRU Open Press fosters a sustainable and inclusive future through innovative projects. Gain insights into our core operations, including our role as a leading provider in web-first publishing, open pedagogy, and scholarship. We'll delve into our proposal process, detail how projects are initiated and navigated, with the goal of sustaining positive change for a diverse, sustainable, and democratic world. Experience the tangible impact of our initiatives through a showcase of successful projects in the evolving landscape of online learning. Explore our open publication strategies, funding mechanisms, and their profound impact on addressing inequities. Learn about our collaborations with faculty, students, Indigenous communities, and local organizations, all contributing to sustaining shared futures through education. Delve into the production processes of our Open Educational Resources (OER) and open pedagogy projects, fostering positive and meaningful change. Join us in shaping the future of education and scholarship through meaningful discussions and building connections for shared knowledge and inclusivity.

3:45 - 4:00 | Break with Coffee & Snack Provided

4:00 - 4:30 | Concurrent Session 12

Session 12.1 | Addressing Inequity

Trottier 2100 (Session C)

Seeking a newer equity, diversity, and inclusion model for educators

Practice

Lorayne Robertson, Jessica Trinier & Roland Van Oostveen | *Ontario Tech University*

Abstract

The complexities of the human condition are evident in myriad ways, yet human differences are used globally to deny basic rights. How differences are perceived in education impacts student access and participation in school, and ultimately the outcomes of their school experience. Courses on equity, diversity and inclusion are one means to help future educators become aware that the benefits of schooling are not equally available to all students. This paper presents a reflective description of a model used for the co-construction of equity, diversity and inclusion courses that employs a community of practice model where student voice features prominently in both course design and course enactment. The model relies on establishing a shared spirit of equity humility for learners and educators, and recognition of the need for student safety in potentially uncomfortable conversations. Basic human rights is an anchoring concept. While, in the past, the teaching of equity has tended to focus on distinct aspects of oppression in society as individual topics, the co-construction of equity model relies, instead, on building bridges of understanding that cross oppressions. The concept of building cross-equity understandings is helpful as a guide to dismantling oppression and guiding the rebuilding of safer, more inclusive spaces in schools.

Session 12.2 | Wildcard

Trottier 2110 (Session D)

Investigating Transformative Technology Integration through Lesson Analysis: A PICRAT Model Pilot Study

Research

Adjoa Mensah, Tina Vo, Peter Wiens & Vanessa Vongkulluksn | *University of Nevada Las Vegas*

i Abstract

According to the Council for Accreditation of Teacher Preparation (CAEP), technology integration is an important component of instructional practice and competency standards. This quantitative pilot study evaluates preservice science lesson plans using the nine domains of the PICRAT model. In a university located in the southwest region of the US, researchers piloted the use of the PICRAT model as a metric for the frequency of technology integration occurrences. Coding for PICRAT domains (passive, interactive, creative, replacement, amplification and transformation) was triangulated among researchers using interrater reliability to ensure consistent coding. The researchers deliberated on the particular benefits and obstacles associated with the PICRAT model and offered perspectives on the feasibility of utilizing the domains to code lesson plans in teacher preparation. These findings suggest a high level of consistency among raters in evaluating different PICRAT domains, particularly in the latter four categories where unanimous agreement was attained.

5:00 - 7:00

See Congress Programming for Social Tent & Food Options

7:00 - 11:59 | OTESSA Social

Saturday, June 15

 Note!

In Person at McGill University

Current time in Montréal (click for more info)

8:00 - 9:00 | Continental Breakfast Provided

8:00-11:30 | Welcome Desk Open

9:00 - 9:15 | Conference Welcome, Announcements, & Land Acknowledgement

Trottier 0060 (Session A)

9:15 - 9:30 | Break

9:30-10:30 | Concurrent Session 13

Session 13.1 | Forthcoming

Trottier 2100 (Session C)

Session 13.2 | Sustaining Positive Change

Trottier 2110 (Session D)

What I Wish Someone had Told Me: Insights on building sustainable impact with open education

Terry Greene | *Trent University*

Apurva Ashok | *The Rebus Foundation*

Carley McDougall & Amanda Grey | *Kwantlen Polytechnic University*

Hugh McGuire | *Pressbooks*

Abstract

Veteran leaders of groundbreaking open education projects and programs reflect on key lessons they have learned (and continue to learn) about community-building, establishing sustainable support systems, and demonstrating impact with open education. This session brings together visionary minds representing different contexts of open education, ranging from system-level initiatives and multi-institution collaborations to institution-level capacity-building and program-level learning design transformation that empowers students using open pedagogy. This session will facilitate organic dialogue between panelists and members of the audience using a modified, participatory “fishbowl” format. Tapping into the rich experience represented at OTESSA convenings, a portion of the panel session will use the “open fishbowl” format that invites audience members to tag into the discussion to ask questions, share comments or insights. This participatory session will surface the creativity and collective wisdom that come from sharing what we glean in failures and successes on the open education journey.

Session 13.3 | Addressing Inequities

Trottier 0060 (Session A)

Designing and Implementing a Framework to Centralize an Accessibility Resource Index Focusing on Teaching & Learning

Practice

Shehroze Saharan, Christopher Laursen & Sara Fulmer | *University of Guelph*

Abstract

The Accessibility Resource Index project addresses the challenge of decentralized accessibility resources within educational institutions. This open-access initiative aims to centralize accessibility resources and streamline access for educators to vital information

on accessibility and accommodations. This project consists of two main components: (1) the Framework and the (2) Exemplary Model. Hosted on an Open Educational Resources (OER) Library, the Framework provides a clear guide for indexing accessibility resources, adaptable for any educational and professional needs. The Exemplary Model, developed using e-learning design software, serves as a practical example of the Accessibility Resource Index focusing on an Ontario post-secondary institution as a use-case. This not only demonstrates the index's application but also inspires other institutions to implement similar accessibility measures. By consolidating these resources into an OER, the project champions the democratization of knowledge and promotes more inclusive teaching practices. It represents a significant step towards reducing educational inequities and enhancing the accessibility of knowledge for faculty, instructors, and educational developers while simultaneously offering a scalable solution for broader educational challenges.

10:30-11:00 | Break

11:00-12:00 | Concurrent Session 14

Session 14.1 | Sustaining Positive Change

Trottier 0060 (Session A)

Approaching Openness as a (Critical) Praxis in Higher Education

Practice

Danielle Dilkes | *University of Western Ontario*

Abstract

Open education “by its very nature open education [can] not be fully delimited or defined” (Noddings & Enright, 1983). Much of the contemporary discourse in higher educational institutions focuses on open access and the development of open educational resources (OERs); however, in open, openness can go beyond OERs. In this session, we will explore multiple meanings of openness, including open as access, open as affordability, open as autonomy, open as control, open as ambiguity, open as freedom, and other conceptualizations of openness. We will then focus on the potential for openness as a critical praxis that can empower students and transform knowledge practices and infrastructures both within and beyond educational institutions. Throughout the session, we will discuss specific open practices that could function as critical pedagogy and discuss potential bar-

riers to achieving this in higher education; however, this session will largely be focused on provocation and discussion. The intent is not to (re)define the ever elusive term “open” in education, but instead to invite each participant to reimagine what it means to practice openness in their own contexts.

Session 14.2 | Transitions of Online Learning and Teaching

Trottier 0070 (Session B)

Sprint to Success: A Journey in Advancing Educators’ Digital Fluency

Practice

Charlotte Delouche & Simon Moll | *eCampusOntario*

Abstract

‘Sprint to Success: A Journey in Advancing Educators’ Digital Fluency’ is a dynamic workshop that centers around the transformative impact of the Ontario Extend Sprints within the micro-credential landscape.

Ontario Extend is a bilingual professional learning program that empowers educators to engage with emerging technologies and pedagogical practices for effective online teaching and learning. Over 1400 educators have completed the program since 2017, earning digital badges and enhancing their digital fluency.

Central to our discussion are the Sprints – concentrated, three-week sessions that have attracted more than 400 educators from 53 varied institutions in Ontario, all aiming to gain digital skills and the Empowered Educator micro-credential.

In the workshop, we will examine the core of these Sprints, revealing a story of collaboration and shared goals in digital literacy. Mirroring the collaborative nature of the Sprints, participants will engage in scenarios inspired by challenges faced during the Sprints, drawn from experiences of Sprint participants, facilitators, and organizers alike. The evolving nature of the Sprints is a focal point, showcasing the importance of collaborative learning and ongoing development in digital education.

Join us to experience and contribute to the ongoing story of digital literacy in education. This workshop is your opportunity to engage with the narrative, add your perspective, and become part of this vibrant community.

Session 14.3 | Sustaining Positive Change

Trottier 2100 (Session C)

11:00 - 11:30 | Using compassion as a way forward in the adoption of open education

Practice

Lydia Watson | *Capilano University*

Abstract

This article explores the use of compassion as an empowering approach to encourage faculty adoption of open educational practices. Despite the growing interest in open education, faculty often face barriers that hinder their engagement. Compassion, as a transformative value, can create an environment of understanding and support among educators.

By cultivating a compassionate culture, faculty can engage in open dialogue, share experiences, and address concerns related to open education adoption. Recognizing individual circumstances and motivations through compassion reduces resistance and fosters openness to change. This article emphasizes the benefits of integrating compassion into open education initiatives.

Drawing on learning theories and digital pedagogies, this article provides practical examples to promote compassion among faculty and support the adoption of open educational resources, open pedagogies, and open-access practices. By embracing compassion, higher education can create an inclusive and supportive environment that encourages faculty to explore and embrace open education.

By recognizing the diverse needs of educators, departments within institutions can foster a compassionate culture that empowers faculty and promotes the benefits of open education. Through compassion, higher education can pave the way for a more open and inclusive educational landscape.

11:30 - 12:00 | Using a Futures Literacy Framework with Preservice Teacher Candidates

Research

Janette Hughes & Laura Morrison | *Ontario Tech University*

Abstract

We will share findings from our qualitative case-study research that examined the use of a Futures Literacy (FL) framework with six preservice teacher candidates (PTCs) as they prepared curriculum resources for a series of B.Ed. workshops focused on digital making. The purpose of the study was to encourage the PTCs to consider how they might design educational experiences for their peers that would help them to consider and reflect on how teachers might explicitly foster student confidence, resiliency, flexibility,

and adaptability – key skills needed to thrive in uncertain times. The PTCs engaged in weekly planning sessions over a semester-long internship and each designed a 90-minute workshop for their peers in the B.Ed. program, using a FL framework, combined with an emerging digital technology (Internet of Things; Artificial Intelligence; Robotics, etc.). Data sources include pre-surveys, artefacts they created, and interviews. The findings suggest that being immersed in a project focused on FL helped the PTCs define, analyze, implement and evaluate a FL approach to teaching and learning that helped them think through how they could plan with the notion of a positive future in mind and how they could help their students foster innovation, resilience, flexibility and adaptability.

12:00 - 1:30 | Break

1:30 - 2:30 | Keynote

Speaker | *Forthcoming*

2:30 - 3:00 | Break

3:00 - 3:45 | Concurrent Session 15

Session 15.1 | Transitions of Online Learning and Teaching

Trottier 2100 (Session C)

3:00 - 3:20 | Sustaining Community: Insights from Collaborative Approaches in Blended Course Design

Practice

Brian Lorraine | *Simon Fraser University*

Abstract

This session presents findings from a comprehensive evaluation of a Faculty Learning Community (FLC) model implemented by the Centre for Educational Excellence (CEE) at Simon Fraser University (SFU), aimed at fostering blended learning practices. Building upon preliminary observations shared at OTESSA '23, the session delves into the

nuanced challenges and insights gleaned from 5 semester-based cohorts over a 3-year period. Through focus group discussions and qualitative analysis of transcripts, the results uncover diverse perspectives on logistical, operational, and pedagogical considerations surrounding blended learning adoption. These insights are particularly timely given the growing trend towards blended/hybrid learning in Canadian post-secondary education, juxtaposed with faculty concerns over workload and burnout (Johnson, 2023). By exploring the implications of sustaining shared futures in higher education, this session invites participants to engage in a critical dialogue on navigating organizational practices centered on intentionality, community, and well-being.

3:25 - 3:45 | Impact of Higher Institution-organised Training and MOOCs on Academic Staffs' Innovative Skills Acquisition

Research

Adebowale Oluwasegun Adebagbo, Ibraheem A. Abdul & Kazeem Adetunji Sodik
| *Yaba College Of Technology, Lagos*

i Note

Teaching and learning innovations focus on improving knowledge content, pedagogy, instructional resources, learning environment and learning outcomes. Using technologies to provide sustainable impacts is good but adopting innovative digital pedagogical resources to facilitate instructional activities for shared future is challenging because of digital skills required. Lacking this knowledge could cause inappropriate integration for pedagogical practices, and problems to learners. In this research, among the Massive Open Online Courses (MOOCs) that the academic staffs used to acquire the digital skills for online learning were the Commonwealth of Learning MOOCs (Technology Enabled Learning MOOC and Open Education Resources MOOC). Considering trainings and the standards, this study investigated innovative/pedagogical digital skills acquired by the academics who participated in the higher institution-organised trainings, compared to those who participated in Massive Open Online Courses in Nigeria. Purposive sampling method was used for the descriptive survey. A validated questionnaire ASOLICQ (0.86 reliability coefficient) was used for data collection. Data were analysed using Frequency count, Percentage, Correlation and Chi-square. Findings revealed a significant difference between levels of skills acquired by the academic staffs trained with the two methods. From the findings, recommendations emphasised provision of quality assurance, engaging hands-on practices, participatory learning reflection sessions and friendly monitoring.

Session 15.2 | Addressing Inequities

Trottier 2110 (Session D)

3:00 - 3:20 | Online interactions and public conversations: Social learning results from a netnographic study of a conservative subreddit

Research

Note

Alongside the seeming decline in recent years of public discourse, civility, and democratic health in society, Canadians have reported very low confidence in our country's media and the country's Federal Parliament (Statistic Canada). Often fed by algorithmic filter bubbles from their own online media consumption, participants find themselves sharing opinion, memes, social media posts, and articles within their homogeneous information stream (Rhodes, 2022) to a receptive audience.

Building upon research establishing a correlation between political misinformation and closed informational systems (Dekeyser, D., and Roose, H., 2022; Rhodes, S. 2022), and using a social learning theory frame, this session will present preliminary findings from a netnographic study of a Canadian conservative subreddit towards informing our role as educators. By identifying and analyzing the social learning lessons revealed from behaviours and discourses on this subreddit, it is hoped this study will provide a deeper understanding of the ways learned and observed behavior can best be harnessed for democratic health.

3:25 - 3:45 | The metadata of translation: Navigating changes to metadata for informed consent in OER translation

Practice

Siri Gauthier | *eCampusOntario*

Abstract

This session discusses metadata's role in accurately reflecting open education resources (OER) and its role in ensuring linguistically and culturally sensitive practices.

A recent initiative by an Open Education Resources (OER) repository in Ontario to provide large scale translation of existing OER to serve its francophone linguistic minority community and the related metadata changes that this project necessitated will be the heart of the discussion. As part of an effort to ensure resources were created, and

recognizing the often-limited capacity for authorship, various modes of translation were considered. As part of this effort, metadata had to reflect the need for potential users to opt-in to materials that were not sensitive to their unique linguistic needs and the realities of the lived experiences of either themselves or their learners.

Ethical considerations surrounding informed consent will be scrutinized, highlighting tailored strategies for obtaining meaningful consent within the unique cultural and linguistic context of the French minority population in Ontario. Attendees can anticipate an insightful session that unpacks the intricate connections between translation, metadata, and informed consent, with a nuanced focus on the multilingual landscape of OER and the linguistic diversity of the French minority in Ontario.

3:45 - 4:00 | Break with Coffee & Snack Provided

4:00 - 4:30 | Concurrent Session 16

Session 16.1 | Transitions of Online Learning and Teaching

Trottier 2100 (Session C)

Connecting in the digital divide: Learners' experiences of relatedness in a hybrid university course

Research

Behnoosh Khoramrooz & Mariel Miller | *University of Victoria*

i Abstract

During the global pandemic, the importance of feeling connected and supported in online learning garnered increased attention as learners reported feelings of isolation and loneliness. According to self-determination theory (SDT), “relatedness,” defined as feeling included and related to others, is one of three basic psychological needs. While the prevalence of online, hybrid, and multi-access modes of learning continues to grow post-pandemic, we currently have little understanding of how learners develop feelings of relatedness during online learning or how relatedness can be supported from their perspective. As such, the purpose of this study is to explore learners’ perceived feelings of relatedness in a large, hybrid, undergraduate course. Specifically, we examined (a) the extent to which learners reported feeling a sense of relatedness in the context of a large hybrid class, and (b) what learners perceive as contributing to their feelings of relat-

edness. By examining relatedness from learners' perspectives, findings can advance our understanding of how to ensure students feel a sense of belonging in their online learning and to improve learners' experience as a consequence.

Session 16.2 | Addressing Inequities

Trottier 2110 (Session D)

Insights: A Window into the Indigenous Economy

Research

Audrey Wubbenhorst | *Humber College*

i Abstract

Canadian post-secondary programs are based on Western worldviews, one of the many challenges the Truth and Reconciliation Commission (TRC) has outlined in its calls to action published in 2015. Academia has consistently marginalized Indigenous voices, despite their integral role in Canada's growth in several areas of life. The TRC has called on Canadians to incorporate Indigenous culture into mainstream teaching to fill this education gap. *Insights* showcases the contributions of Indigenous-owned businesses to Canada's economic development through qualitative methods. Applicable to various post-secondary programs, *Insights* delivers revitalized learning modes through present-day case studies and in-depth interviews supplemented with teaching notes. These materials explore the accomplishments of Indigenous entrepreneurs and business owners from several sectors and the challenges and barriers they have faced. By displaying diverse representation in business, new possibilities in academic inclusion can unfold, demonstrating to Indigenous and non-Indigenous people the strength that evolves in the face of adversity. The findings of this research will empower educators and students to create academic and social impacts, benefiting not only Indigenous communities but also local businesses.

5:00 - 7:00

See Congress Programming for Social Tent & Food Options

7:00 - 11:59 | OTESSA Social

Sunday, June 16

IMPORTANT!

There are no sessions scheduled for Sunday, June 16. We trust you will have a safe and uneventful trip home.
See you online tomorrow!

Part II

Online Only Sessions

Monday, June 17

 Note!

Online Only. All times Eastern Daylight Time.

Current time in Montréal (click for more info)

11:00 - 11:30 | Co-Located Shared Meet-Up | Drop-In

11:30 - 12:00 | Conference Welcome, Announcements, & Land Acknowledgement

12:00 - 1:00 | Keynote

Speaker | *Forthcoming*

1:00 - 1:15 | Break

1:15 - 2:45 | Concurrent Session 17

Session 17.1 | Transitions of Online Learning and Teaching

1:15 - 2:15 | Procurement and Vendor Relations as Leverage Points for Ethics in Ed Tech

Practice

Stephanie Moore & Heather Tillberg-Webb | *University of New Mexico*

Abstract

Practitioners are not always in a design role or design-only role but also in roles where technology selection, procurement, and implementation are primary tasks. Procurement and technology selection processes can be significant leverage points for integrating ethical considerations – such as accessibility, data rights, and privacy – into educational technology decision making through selection and purchasing. Doing so often relies on the nature of the relationship that instructional design and academic tech teams have with vendors, and those relationships can vary greatly from one vendor to another.

This session will explore experiences with various vendors and examples of how dialogue and collaboration with a responsive vendor can impact learning and non-learning related outcomes, and can save a project. We will also explore examples where breakdowns in review and procurement processes or communications with a vendor had deleterious outcomes for implementing an ed tech product into the learning ecosystem. These examples and non-examples help to identify particular points in the process of dealing with vendors from standards development to procurement to implementation to on-going partnerships and also discuss multi-party vendor relationships. We will share examples from our own current and previous experiences in various roles across our careers as a VP of academic technology, Director of Instructional Design, and instructional designers (see Appendix A). We will also invite session participants to share examples from their own work.

2:15 - 2:45 | Connecting Threads: Exploring the Link between Academic Helpseeking and Student Sense of Belonging in Online Learning

Research

Lawrence Armo Biney & Mariel Miller | *University of Victoria*

Abstract

Students' sense of belonging and their ability to engage in adaptive help-seeking are key factors to consider when supporting online, post-secondary learning. However, to date, few studies have examined how these factors intertwine to support academic performance in online learning environments. Using a theoretical framework of self-regulated learning, this study explores the relationship between students' self-reported sense of belonging in an online learning tutorial and their engagement in adaptive and maladaptive help-seeking behaviors in the course. The participants were undergraduate students in a first-year, hybrid course. Sense of belonging was assessed using the sense of belonging subscale in the Perceived Cohesion scale. Academic help-seeking was measured using a scale adapted from Karabenick (2004) and Han (2014). Results are presented using descriptive statistics and a correlation matrix. These preliminary findings are the first

steps in a larger MA thesis, which aims to contribute to a broader understanding of the interplay between a sense of belonging and help-seeking in online classrooms, paving the way for the design of supportive online learning.

Session 17.2 | Addressing Inequities

1:15 - 2:15 | Reflections on a Canadian Framework for Indigenous Open Education Development

Practice

Brad Wuetherick & Kayla Larson | *University of British Columbia*

Abstract

Facilitated by two Indigenous scholars (both of Métis and European ancestry), this session delves into insights gleaned from the Indigenous OER Summit 2024 held earlier this year at the University of British Columbia. In February 2024, a collective effort amongst Indigenous parties interested in open education, composed of students, faculty, and librarians, laid the groundwork for a Canadian framework outlining best practices for Indigenous open educational resource (OER) development. This presentation sheds light on the day's proceedings, emphasizing collaborative processes, discoveries, and outcomes. The conversation extends to post-summit initiatives, focusing on refining documentation and gathering feedback on the framework. Attendees can anticipate a thorough exploration of summit activities, the subsequent steps in framework development, and the plans for additional feedback. The presenters will also share their strategy for disseminating the framework. Moreover, the session outlines future national advocacy plans in support of Indigenous OER development. A substantial portion of the session will be dedicated to group discussion and audience feedback on the framework process and its details, by eliciting response to a series of questions posed by the presenters.

2:15 - 2:45 | Role of Social Media in Addressing Educational Inequality: A Critical Examination of Marginalized Teens' Social Media Usage

Research

Daeun Jung | *Florida State University*

Abstract

Although digital technology is valorized for its promises in empowering individual learners and democratize educational opportunities, such hopeful imaginaries need to be critically revisited. What is the role of social media in addressing educational inequality? This study aims to unravel the question by examining the role of social media in the college choice system of potential first-generation college students. The study adopts a multiple case study approach, engaging with eleven high school seniors, whose parents did not complete a 4-year college/university. Two interviews and a week of social media diary data were collected. The themes revealed the teens' contradictory views toward the role of social media in their college choice system: (1) abundant but insufficient information, (2) helpful but not impactful for college choice, and (3) inspiring but distressing experiences. The contradictions uncover the important role of the in-person support system and resources embedded in marginalized teens' college choice system, underscoring the pre-existing inequalities in their social contexts. Based on the results, I critically discuss the role of social media in addressing educational inequality, particularly the optimism around digital informal learning, and provide suggestions for formal schooling to enhance marginalized teens' college access.

Session 17.3 | Wildcard

1:15 - 2:15 | Breaking Down Barriers: Using Docsify-This As an Entry Point to Markdown Open Publishing

Workshop

Paul Hibbitts | *Hibbitts Design*

Abstract

The educational experience in the Dental Hygiene Program consists of didactic lectures, simulation labs, and clinical experiences. Although the recent surge of curriculum renovation in dental and medical schools centers around enhancing student engagement and active learning, didactic teaching remains teacher-focused, involving students as passive learners only. H5P is an open platform for creating and sharing interactive HTML5 learning content. Oral biology (OBIOL 302) is a foundational science course offered to third-year students in the Dental Hygiene (DH) program. A large set of H5P content was created and provided to students through the learning management system as supplementary material. A study was conducted to evaluate the impact of these interactive H5P contents on students' learning experiences. Anonymized student performance data from the summative exam were analyzed, and a survey was administered. Students per-

formed better in questions for which H5P supplements were provided. The results from the survey showed satisfaction and perceived benefit of using H5P as supplementary content in didactic lectures. Students appreciated the content's interactive nature and expressed willingness to have similar experiences in our courses. Our findings indicate that the H5P platform has the potential to redefine didactic teaching by fostering an active learning environment.

2:15 - 2:45 | Application of Interactive H5P Learning Content in a Dental Hygiene Course

Practice

Nazlee Sharmin & Ava K. Chow | *University of Alberta*

Abstract

The educational experience in the Dental Hygiene Program consists of didactic lectures, simulation labs, and clinical experiences. Although the recent surge of curriculum renovation in dental and medical schools centers around enhancing student engagement and active learning, didactic teaching remains teacher-focused, involving students as passive learners only. H5P is an open platform for creating and sharing interactive HTML5 learning content. Oral biology (OBIOL 302) is a foundational science course offered to third-year students in the Dental Hygiene (DH) program. A large set of H5P content was created and provided to students through the learning management system as supplementary material. A study was conducted to evaluate the impact of these interactive H5P contents on students' learning experiences. Anonymized student performance data from the summative exam were analyzed, and a survey was administered. Students performed better in questions for which H5P supplements were provided. The results from the survey showed satisfaction and perceived benefit of using H5P as supplementary content in didactic lectures. Students appreciated the content's interactive nature and expressed willingness to have similar experiences in our courses. Our findings indicate that the H5P platform has the potential to redefine didactic teaching by fostering an active learning environment.

2:45 - 3:00 | Break

3:00 - 3:45 | Concurrent Session 18 | Forthcoming

3:45 - 4:00 | Break

4:00 - 4:30 | Social Guest

4:30 - 5:00 | Discussion/Networking Pod Drop-In

Tuesday, June 18

Note!

Online Only. All times Eastern Daylight Time.

Current time in Montréal (click for more info)

11:00 - 11:30 | Co-Located Shared Meet-Up | Drop-In

11:30 - 12:00 | Conference Welcome, Announcements, & Land Acknowledgement

12:00 - 1:00 | Ethics in Design Showcase 19

Showcase 19.1 | Addressing Inequities

Speculative Design in a Summer Camp: Tensions around Infantilization

Research

Madalyn Wilson-Fetrow | *University of New Mexico*

Abstract

Summer camps offer opportunities for youth to learn technical skills and apply them in service of solving wicked problems, like climate change and social/economic injustices. While many camps want youth to bring their experiences, they anticipate that campers will share happy or optimistic experiences, contributing to a sense of hopeful, if idealistic and unrealistic solutions to pressing issues. Those who administer and facilitate such learning experiences encounter youth who passionately want to tackle these problems, but who are not naïve regarding the harms surrounding climate disaster and racial injustice.

In this session, we present examples of design challenges that—through participants’ perspectives and an ideation technique—became more speculative and critical. We supported our middle school participants to use the Wrong Theory Protocol to generate harmful and humiliating ideas prior to generating beneficial solutions. In doing so, some facilitators—who came from higher SES settings than the campers—became uncomfortable with the darkness of participants’ ideas, which included policy brutality, gun violence, etc., and stemmed from their everyday experiences of poverty. In this way, facilitators’ infantilization of participants is a tension present in many such designs, and one which we aim to trouble, using structural analysis of videos and artifacts.

Showcase 19.2 | Addressing Inequities

Speculative Design and Building a Community of Transformation

Practice

Kristen Ferris, Vanessa Svihla, Susannah Davis & Nadia Kellam | *University of New Mexico*

Abstract

Organizational change efforts commonly fail in higher education. Those aimed at diversity, equity, inclusion, and justice (DEIJ) goals face complex barriers, with successful change depending on changes to policies, organizational culture, and norms that disrupt established power dynamics. We argue speculative design is an important tool in such work, enabling change agents to sustain commitment and develop more just visions.

We describe our use of speculative design, remixing, and futurisms in forming a DEIJ-oriented Community of Transformation (CoT) comprising higher education change agents from institutional change leadership teams (e.g., NSF ADVANCE, RED, INCLUDES, etc.) in STEM departments. Using these design tools, we aim to foster change agents’ commitment to and capacity for DEIJ-oriented systems change. We detail precedent - theory and practice - that forms the argument for our design work, with attention to the complex ways that situated understandings of learning, an intersectional approach to power, and organizational change imbue this work. We illustrate our use of speculative design, sharing examples of community building and arts-based activities like trading cards and ’zines, as well as learning through media clubs. We share successes and challenges, including discomfort with activities that appear to be a step away from academic productivity.

Showcase 19.3 | Addressing Inequities

Open Learning Design in Context: Expanding the Continuum

Research

Verena Roberts & Michelle Harrison | *University of Calgary*

Abstract

Our conceptual paper examines open-learning approaches from a design perspective that takes a more systematic view which is not intended to promote the replication of open-learning design models. Instead, this paper is written to highlight how educators can find connections and possible integration to their own learning contexts to design with principles that could lead to more equitable, accessible and responsive learning environments for all learners. The Open Learning Design Continuum (OLDC) is an ever-changing and evolving collaborative learning design model that examines the potential principles of open learning design in multiple higher education contexts. Through a comparison of case studies of open curriculum designs at two Canadian HE institutions, we will examine ways that educators and learners have experienced a variety of approaches to open learning design, including the blurring of informal/formal spaces, the uses of open educational resources (OER) and open platforms to create more student-centered, equitable and accessible learning spaces.

1:00 - 1:15 | Break

1:15 - 2:45 | Concurrent Session 20

Session 20.1 | Wildcard

1:15 - 2:15 | Implementing the “Code of Best Practices in Fair Dealing for Open Educational Resources (OER).”

Practice

Ann Ludbrook | *Toronto Metropolitan University*

Abstract

In 2022, the Canadian Association of Research Libraries formed a working group to adapt the US Code of Best Practices in Fair Use for Open Educational Resources. This effort

aimed to alleviate the lack of practical guidance available to open educational resource (OER) developers when handling third-party copyrighted material.

The resulting Canadian Code, completed by late 2023, provides a legally sound basis for applying fair dealing in OER creation. This session introduces the Code, focusing on the background of the US and Canadian codes and how they are different, references the legal landscape, discusses the Code's four key use cases and practical application for OER creators, outlines how to implement the code through some examples as well as suggesting institutional adoption strategies.

This discussion will be led by Ann Ludbrook, Toronto Metropolitan University and include other members of the working group which included Rowena Wake, University of Calgary, Heather Martin, University of Guelph, Josh Dickson, University of New Brunswick, and Stephanie Savage, University of British Columbia.

The session allows time for comments and questions at the end of presentation to allow for group discussion.

2:15 - 2:45 | Decoding New Literacies: Core Concepts, Competencies, and Outcomes in Algorithm Literacy

Research

Marta Samokishyn | *Saint Paul University*

i Abstract

Literacy is defined as being deictic in nature, i.e. its definition can “change rapidly as [its] context changes” (Leu et al., 2018, p. 319). As new technologies and social challenges emerge, new literacies appear to respond to the needs, challenges, and opportunities associated with this change, in fact, “new technologies regularly and repeatedly transform previous literacies, continually redefining what it means to become literate” (Leu et al., 2018, p. 327; Lund et al., 2023).

While algorithm literacy has been talked about for a while, according to Dogruel and colleagues (2022), it is still in its infancy and remains a relatively new field of study. In fact, while there is an increasing awareness among many about the impact of algorithmic systems on our socio-digital ecosystems, algorithm literacies have not yet been widely incorporated into the corpus of North American post-secondary education (Head et al., 2020). This calls for the increased visibility of algorithm literacy among scholars, as well as clear definitions that could inform the practice.

Thus, this research stems from a pressing need to understand the core elements of algorithm literacy as a growing field. The presenter will provide theoretical findings of a scoping review about functional definitions of algorithm literacy, its' core concepts, competencies, and outcomes. These theoretical findings of this study will lay the foundation

for those who engage in the curriculum development and delivery of algorithm literacy intervention in the educational context.

Session 20.2 | Sustaining Positive Change

1:15 - 1:45 | A sensory exploration of inaccessible digital practices: Culturally acceptable marginalization in praxis.

Research

Kim Ashbourne | *University of Victoria*

Abstract

Globally, post-pandemic researchers in the field of digital accessibility research in education have concluded that despite the potential for information and communication technology (ICT) to remove barriers for learners with disabilities, post-secondary institutions continue to fall short of effectively using ICT to deliver equitable educative experiences to learners with disabilities (Seale, 2020). Digital accessibility frameworks, checklists, policies and various legislative “sticks” (as opposed to carrots) have been around for decades (Oswal & Meloncon, 2017; Seale, 2004, 2006) but the problem persists. Accessibility and inclusion are viscerally relevant to disabled learners’ lived experience of post-secondary education. Digital accessibility and inaccessibility touch our bodies, minds, ethics, and our sense of self-in-community. This session uses learning artifacts, personal accounts and praxis provocations from the CanDARE.ca praxis project (Ashbourne, 2024) as jumping-off points for group discussions. The goal of this session is to get more people thinking and talking about the role digital inaccessibility plays in the education system’s oppression of learners with disabilities. Furthermore, we need to start talking about the Academy’s complicity in the silent marginalization of people with disabilities in the digital commons.

1:45 - 2:15 | A Flipped Class Room Approach to Paralegal Education

Research

Ashley Stasiewicz, Bruce Thomson & Tyra Zaguirre | *MacEwan University*

Abstract

Legal education traditionally follows two distinct paths, catering to law school students and legal studies majors. However, the training of paralegals, vital contributors to the legal workforce, often lacks comprehensive pedagogical research and effective instruc-

tional models. This presentation addresses the gap in legal education for non-lawyers, particularly paralegals, by exploring the implementation of a flipped classroom approach. Current paralegal programs predominantly focus on clerical skills, leaving a deficit in higher-level legal comprehension and analytical abilities required in the field. Drawing on the success of flipped classroom models in law schools, this study aims to assess whether such an approach can enhance learner engagement and deepen understanding of fundamental legal principles among paralegal students.

Guided by the research question, “Does implementing a flipped classroom instructional approach in an Alberta university legal technology course for paralegals change learner engagement with the fundamental legal knowledge appropriate for paralegals, compared to lecture-based models?” the presentation will share findings from survey data collected in April 2024.

By examining the impact of flipped classrooms on paralegal education, this research contributes to the ongoing discourse on innovative pedagogies in legal instruction. The insights gained from this study can inform curriculum development, address the challenges paralegals face, and ensure they acquire the necessary competencies for success in the legal industry.

2:15 - 2:45 | Power to the People: Digital Humanities for/as Community Development

Research

Keith Cheng | *University of Toronto*

Abstract

“Digital Humanities” (DH) has been a rapidly growing field within academia, used to broadly describe scholarship situated in the intersection of technology and the humanities. While the field was originally conceptualized with radical intentions to move toward “the democratization of culture and scholarship” (Schnapp and Presner, 2009), it has become increasingly institutionalized and largely detached from these radical origins. In a time where there is a growing digital divide (Darko et al., 2023) and heightened concerns around the harmful impacts of new technologies (Benjamin, 2019), imagining new futures for the field of digital humanities is crucial. Putting digital humanities in conversation with scholarship from the fields of human and community development, the author argues that digital humanities is a radical site of possibility where agency and solidarity can be developed (Bhattacharyya, 2004), understandings of the self and one’s position within the larger world can be negotiated (Collins, 2006; Freire, 1968), and power can be decentralized from the university. The author employs Nancy Fraser’s theory of justice to develop a framework for equitable digital humanities work, discussing tangible strategies and potential barriers to its application through an autoethnographic account

of their experiences developing digital humanities programming for underrepresented students at a Historically Black College/University (HBCU). The paper will discuss both the process and product of digital humanities, exploring how the process of doing digital humanities can have transformative impact for those involved and how new technologies can help facilitate wider and more diverse public engagements with digital humanities work.

Session 20.3 | Transitions of Online Learning and Teaching

1:15 - 2:15 | A world of pure imagination: scaling learning design with a design system

Workshop

Joyce Seitzinger | *RMIT Online*

Abstract

In the post-pandemic era, educational institutions face the critical task of scaling up digital learning options. This transition reveals a fundamental challenge: bespoke design, the traditional approach in academia, is not scalable. To address this, our workshop introduces design systems as a scalable framework for crafting digital learning experiences. Attendees will learn from experts and case studies across industries, understanding how reusable components and clear standards not only streamline the development process but also ensure consistency and facilitate cross-disciplinary collaboration. Key objectives include mastering design system fundamentals, overcoming bespoke design limitations, and fostering innovation within education.

2:15 - 2:45 | Open education and the Ontario governmental postsecondary virtual learning agenda

Research

Mara De Giusti Bordignon | *Western University*

Abstract

Open education (OE) is a solution to combat problems of affordability and access in higher education. In Canada, the growing importance of open educational resources and practices is evident through the rising demand for, and expanding availability of, open textbooks and courses. With the growth of OE, Canadian provincial governments and postsecondary institutions have begun to address OE through policy yet there is

a gap in our understanding of how OE has become factored into governmental agenda setting for Ontario postsecondary institutions. The main research question asks, how has OE become prominently featured in the Ontario governmental virtual learning agenda in recent years? This study uses a Multiple Streams Approach (MSA) as a method to interrogate five streams, e.g., problem, policy, political, entrepreneurial, and policy window, which converge to influence both agenda setting and decision making. The policy stream enables the analysis of policy documents pertaining to Ontario's Virtual Learning Strategy (VLS). Preliminary findings identify the role of local and international policy entrepreneurs, and the leveraging of the COVID-19 pandemic as a window of opportunity. This study is significant in its ability to trace contributing factors towards an OE policy agenda for Ontario postsecondary institutions.

2:45 - 3:00 | Break

3:00 - 3:45 | Unconference

3:45 - 4:00 | Break

4:00 - 4:30 | Social Guest

4:30 - 5:00 | Discussion/Networking Pod Drop-In